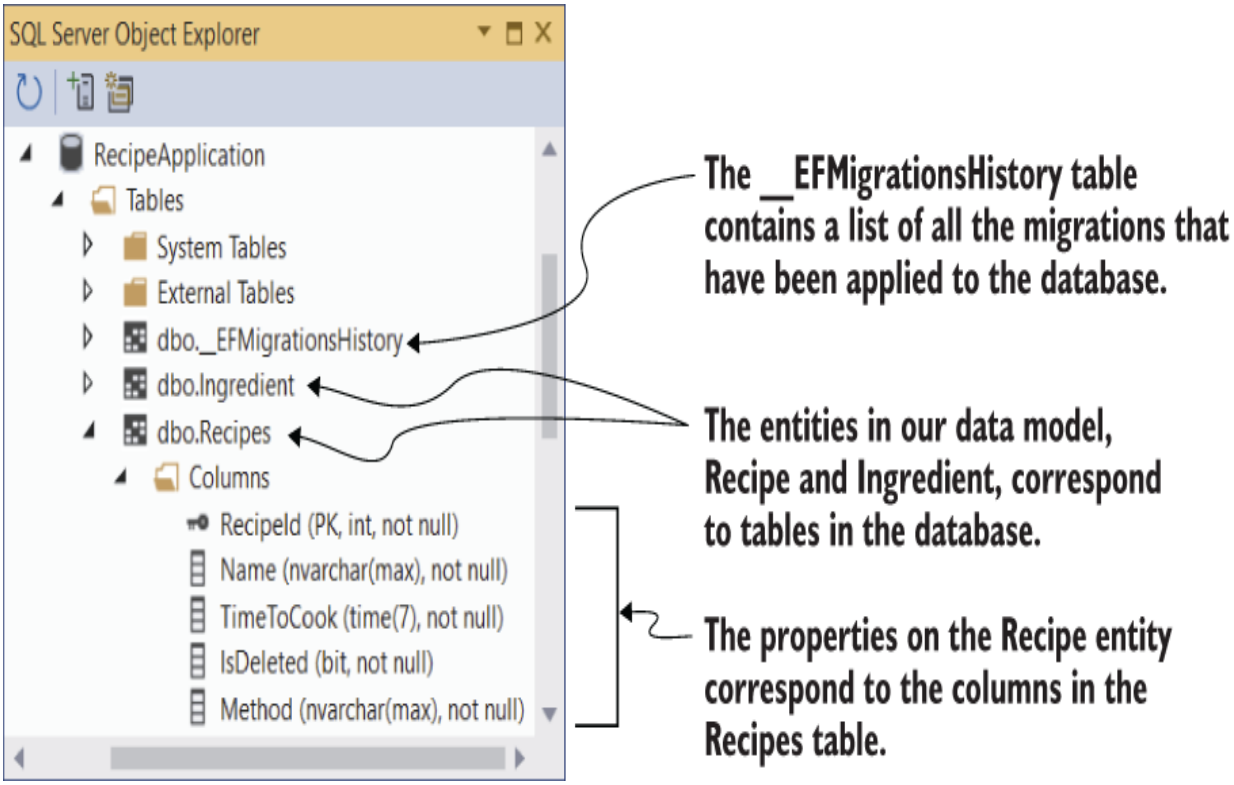


Figure 12.7 Applying migrations to a database creates the database if it doesn't exist and updates the database to match EF Core's internal data model. The list of applied migrations is stored in the __EFMigrationsHistory table.

NOTE If you get an error message saying `No project was found` when running these commands, check that you're running them in your application's project folder, not the top-level solution folder.

When you apply the migrations to the database, EF Core creates the necessary tables in the database and adds the appropriate columns and keys. You may have also noticed the __EFMigrationsHistory table, which EF Core uses to store the names of migrations that it's applied to the database. Next time you run `dotnet ef database update`, EF Core can compare this table with the list of migrations in your app and apply only the new ones to your database.